overseas tour. The guys are *always* overweight – we're talking excess baggage now.

But before I digress … So, ja, our luggage always weighs too much, especially after a trip to the subcontinent. In Pakistan, for example, the guys buy tons of carpets and leather jackets. Don't ask me why. I mean, I can understand the carpets, but not the leather jackets. It must say something about some of the guys' dress sense! Anyway, excess luggage is never ever an issue when Goolam's in the house. After being in the business for so long, he's made so many contacts all over the world that any problems just seem to melt away. Another benefit of being part of an international sports team is that we never have to clear customs either.

Goolam is so good at what he does that I got the Deccan Chargers to sign him up for the IPL. When the tournament was held in South Africa in 2009, the Chargers needed a team manager, and I was like, 'Well, you guys had better get Goolam on board before anyone else snaps him up.'

It's also great to have Goolam in India – he understands Indian culture. He's always telling us, 'Whenever you come to the subcontinent, make sure you pack an extra bag. That's the bag of patience.' He knows that everything takes just that little bit longer to happen in India. The job will get done, but it just takes a while.

Fortunately, the Chargers signed him just in time. I think Graeme Smith had been keen to get him for the Rajasthan Royals, but Goolam opted for the Chargers and his favourite son …

That's Goolam the team manager. But Goolam is also one of the most humble and kindest people I've ever met. The Proteas regard him as a father figure, and I secretly think Goolam sees us all as his kids. He's very soft-spoken, courteous and quite shy. You often see Goolam blush – even through his complexion – when he has to say a few things that he's not comfortable saying. Goolam also withdraws into his shell when he feels people are talking in a provocative manner. He goes quiet and just sort of sits back, and he never really challenges people. And as I illustrated in the story about Andrew Symonds teasing Goolam, he finds it difficult to say no to people, because he genuinely wants to help and accommodate everyone.

Goolam has tried to retire before, but he came back when the UCB sent out a desperate SOS. When Goolam finally takes a very well-earned rest, it will be a huge loss to South African cricket. While some of the Proteas have taken Goolam for granted over the years, the rest of us treat him with the